

Zion Smith

Senior AI Python Full Stack Engineer | FastAPI, Django, React, LLMs, AWS

✉ zionsmith891@outlook.com ☎ +1 (805) 395-9028 📍 Moreno Valley, CA

🌐 [linkedin.com/in/zion-smith-213012152](https://www.linkedin.com/in/zion-smith-213012152)

Profile

Senior AI Full-Stack Engineer with 10+ years of experience designing and building scalable web, mobile, and cloud-based applications. Strong expertise in modern frontend frameworks such as React, Next.js, TypeScript, and Angular, as well as backend systems using Node.js and Python (FastAPI). Experienced in developing AI-powered solutions with LLMs, LangChain, and RAG architectures. Proven track record of delivering high-performance SaaS platforms, enterprise systems, and real-time, data-driven applications in production environments.

Professional Experience

Lead Software Engineer , <i>DockYard, Inc.</i>	04/2023 – 12/2025 Hingham, MA
- Built frontend applications using React, Next.js, TypeScript, and developed backend services using Python (FastAPI), delivering scalable APIs and smooth end-to-end user experiences. - Improved system performance to sub-180ms API latency through backend optimization, caching strategies, and architecture tuning. Increased search relevance by 35% using Elasticsearch with NLP and LLM-based ranking pipelines. - Achieved 99.95% uptime and reduced cloud costs by 22% through AWS optimization and Docker-based microservices, improving overall infrastructure efficiency and stability. - Reduced release cycles from multiple days to about 1 hour using CI/CD automation, and lowered production defects by 30% by improving testing, monitoring, and deployment processes.	
Senior Full Stack Python Developer , <i>TekRevol</i>	05/2020 – 11/2022 Houston, TX
- Led multi-product SaaS development across distributed teams, delivering scalable production systems for web and backend platforms in a fast-paced environment. - Built a cloud-native SaaS platform using Python (Django) and React, integrated with IoT telemetry systems, automating 12+ hours/week of manual workflows for 3K+ users. - Improved system scalability by 40% through Kubernetes-based microservices architecture, backend optimization, and distributed system design, handling traffic spikes of 10K+ requests per minute. - Reduced API latency from 820ms to 260ms (~68%) by optimizing Python backend services, database queries, caching strategies (Redis), and data processing pipelines. - Strengthened platform security by 55% reduction in vulnerabilities through secure backend engineering practices and improved CI/CD automation workflows. - Improved user experience by implementing LLM-powered semantic search, recommendation systems, and dynamic UI enhancements, reducing query resolution time by 28%.	

Full Stack Python Developer, Binti

05/2017 – 10/2019

San Francisco, CA

- Delivered a production web platform serving 8K+ users, improving overall system performance by ~25% through backend optimization, API enhancements, and Redis-based caching strategies using a Python (Django/Flask) backend with React frontend.
- Improved backend efficiency by ~18% through service refactoring, database query optimization (PostgreSQL/MySQL), and improved request handling across distributed services.
- Increased frontend performance score from 58 → 85 by optimizing React rendering, reducing bundle size by 30%, and improving state management and component efficiency.
- Built and maintained real-time analytics dashboards using Python/Node.js services and React, achieving ~700ms latency, enabling faster KPI tracking and operational decision-making.

Junior Developer, Sidebench

06/2015 – 07/2016

Los Angeles, CA

- Built reusable MERN components and internal libraries, improving development efficiency across projects.
- Streamlined workflows with Docker, cutting setup time from ~1.5 hours to under 20 minutes, and optimized APIs and database queries.
- Collaborated with designers and senior engineers to deliver features, while supporting CI pipelines and code reviews to ensure code quality.

Education

Bachelor's Degree on Computer Science, Neumont University

2010 – 2014

Salt Lake, Utah

Skills

Frontend

React.js, Next.js, Angular, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS, Redux, HTML5/CSS3

Testing & QA

PyTest, xUnit, Mocha, Chai

Database

PostgreSQL, MYSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, ClickHouse

Backend

Python (FastAPI / Flask), Node.js (Express / NestJS), RESTful APIs, GraphQL, Scalable Backend Systems

Cloud & DevOps

AWS (Lambda, S3, EC2), Docker, Kubernetes, Firebase, Vercel, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Terraform

AI/ML Integration

OpenAI API, LangChain, TensorFlow, PyTorch, Scikit-learn